

“HOW **INAPPROPRIATE** TO CALL THIS PLANET EARTH WHEN IT IS **QUITE CLEARLY OCEAN.**”

Arthur C. Clarke, British writer, 1917–2008



main
propellor

thruster
provides power
for forward
movement

3 THE NUMBER OF PASSENGERS
26 ft THE LENGTH OF **NAUTILE**
4.6 miles THE RANGE OF **NAUTILE**

1956

Mid-ocean ridge
Marie Tharp and Bruce Heezen, American oceanographers, discover the mid-ocean ridge—an undersea ridge running down the Atlantic seabed.



Trieste

1960

Descent to the bottom

The bathyscaphe (diving vessel) *Trieste* dives 35,797 ft (10,911 m) down the Pacific's Marianas Trench, to make the first descent to the deepest part of the ocean.

1984

Nautilo

The bathyscaphe *Nautilo* is used to film the wreck of the RMS *Titanic* and search for the flight data recorder from Air France Flight 447, which crashed into the Atlantic Ocean in 2009.

2000–10

Marine census

A Census of Marine Life that catalogued the diversity of life in oceans worldwide is completed in 2010. This octopus is one of the many strange discoveries.

Dumbo
octopus



1872–76

HMS Challenger

On its voyage around the world, the HMS *Challenger* collects a huge amount of data about the oceans.

Samples from ocean floor



1968

Deep sea drilling

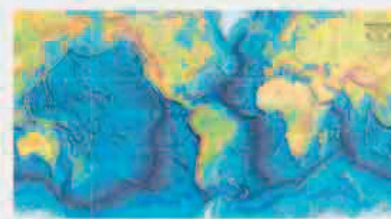
Rock samples taken from the mid-ocean ridge show magnetic striping confirming that the ocean floor is actively spreading.

1977

Ocean floor

Marie Tharp and Bruce Heezen make the first accurate relief map of all the world's ocean floors, mainly using data recorded by sonar.

Map of ocean floor



2012

Deepsea Challenger

Canadian filmmaker James Cameron goes to the bottom of the Marianas Trench in the submersible *Deepsea Challenger* and makes a film about life there.